**A year of flourishing – Korokoro Environment Group 25/26 year**

There has a lot that has been flourishing in Korokoro this year. KEG has had a busy year with a lot of things happening in parallel:

- KNE Small Mammal Monitoring
    - Julie Haggie continues to coordinate volunteers for pest monitoring twice yearly – a valuable contribution to a long-term tracking programme that has been managed by Greater Wellington Regional Council (GWRC) since 2009.
- Pest trapping
    - Andre Oliver continues to coordinate a flourishing network of traps and trappers around the suburb
    - KEG people also contribute to pest trapping in the Korokoro Stream valley of the Regional Park, under the banner of Pest Free Puke Ariki.
- Community Garden
    - A lot of veges, fruit, preschoolers and adults have flourished in the Community Garden at Huggins Hollow over the past year, thanks to Lesley Smith for enthusiasm and communications.
- Keeping an eye on proposals for Petone to Grenada road
    - We coordinated with others in Korokoro and beyond to raise concerns about the environmental and community impact of the proposed Petone to Grenada road, including working with a Korokoro Residents group, and groups in Petone. As it stands, the road is still proposed, but it's not flourishing, as it's close to the bottom of a very long list, with an increasing price tag of $330/mm.
- Planting & maintaining plantings
    - We had lots of enthusiasm for planting, pre-planting preparation, and plant maintenance. Which was good because we had a large number of plants from our grant, directly from GWRC and from Hutt City Council.
    - It has been great to see plants thriving on London Road and in the stream site, and new plantings at Puketitiro and the Korokoro-Percy's Track.
- Stream health monitoring
    - Tessa Roberts, Lesley Smith, Gillian Woodward, Anthony Davies, Andre Oliver and Tamsin Falconer all participated in stream sampling during the year. Thanks to Amanda Valois at TW, the samples were analysed and a report commissioned by Greater Wellington, which we're excited to share.
- Belmont Regional Park
    - Clive Woodward, Andre Oliver, Ants Davies and Tamsin Falconer were part of formal engagement over the future of the park, and many have contributed to our relationship with Greater Wellington parks staff. Ants also provides a link as the convenor of the Friends of Belmont Regional Park, linking us with other like-minded groups.
    - We've had a lot of support from Peta McMillan, Bruce Forster and other parks staff.
- Pest plants
    - Andre has continued his work on reducing pest plants, and has had great support from Claudia Eustace at Hutt City Council. It's great to be contributing to wider work to monitor emerging problems such as cherries using drones.

- Behind the scenes
    - We have a refreshed logo thanks to the work of local graphic designer Tessa Baty.
    - Thanks to Jenny Black with support from Julie Haggie, our finances are well managed and tracked, making reporting on our grant from Greater Wellington as straightforward as possible.
    - Olly Betts continues to keep our website up to date, particularly important as Facebook reduces in impact and desirability as a communication mode!
    - We appreciate the ongoing enthusiasm and encouragement from Ruth Mansell in particular, as a long term stalwart of the group.

It's a pleasure to be part of a group that contributes to our environment and community in all these ways as we celebrate 25 years as an organisation.

Tamsin Falconer

Chairperson

16 August 2026